

bandwidth, such as dial-up modem, connections provide rates in the range of 56 Kbps, while high-bandwidth, or broadband, connections deliver more information at a much faster speed, making possible, for example, full-screen, full-motion video.

Beacon

In wireless networking, a beacon is a packet sent by a connected device to inform other devices of its presence and readiness.

Beacon interval

When a wirelessly networked device sends a beacon, it includes with it a beacon interval, which specifies the period of time before it will send the beacon again. The interval tells receiving devices on the network how long they can wait in low-power mode before waking up to handle the beacon. Network managers can adjust the beacon interval, usually measured in milliseconds (ms), or its equivalent, kilomicroseconds (Kmsec).

Bluetooth

A wireless computing and telecommunications specification that defines how mobile personal computing devices work with each other and with regular computer and phone systems, within a close range. It uses the 2.4 GHz band at 720 Kbps within a 30-foot range. This technology is used with Personal Area Networks (PANs), as opposed to LANs.

BSS

Basic Service Set. When a WLAN is operating in infrastructure mode, each access point and its connected devices are called the Basic Service Set.

BSSID

The unique identifier for an access point in a BSS network. Also see SSID.

Cable

A broadband transmission technology using coaxial cable or